

# Philipp Hilbert. *Technical Product Owner, WealthTech & Capital Markets.*

*Positioning*, hands-on Technical Product Owner with 13 years shipping integration-heavy B2B platforms, fluent in REST APIs and AI-native tooling, ready to relocate to Abu Dhabi.

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## § WHY SALT

Salt's client is building an AI-native wealth management and trading platform for banks across the GCC, a space where the integration surface is genuinely hard: FIX protocol, real-time transaction states, async notification flows, and enterprise buyers who will not tolerate flaky error handling. That specificity is what attracted me. Most fintech PM roles are payments-adjacent; a platform wiring prime brokerage workflows into mobile-first bank portals is a different order of complexity, and the requirement to prototype directly against real APIs rather than hand the work to engineering is exactly how I prefer to operate. *That is precisely the environment where working at the code level rather than describing it pays off.*

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## § AI-NATIVE STACK

*Daily tools, not buzzwords.*

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec and edge-case generation
- **Cursor / VSCode**, AI-assisted development and prototyping
- **GitHub Copilot**, inline code suggestions across Python and Kotlin
- **Lovable**, rapid mobile and web prototype scaffolding against real APIs
- **Framer**, design-heavy interactive prototypes and journey mapping
- **GPT**, requirements drafting, acceptance-criteria review, and research synthesis

- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation and integration testing pipelines
  - **Gamma.app**, stakeholder-facing product briefs and sprint demos
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## § TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

*Shipped with, not just listed.*

REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, Azure DevOps, GitLab, Django, SQL, Dagster, dbt, Jira, Confluence.

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## § SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

*Zero-to-one B2B marketplace for construction staffing, built and operated solo.*

- Two-sided matching platform connecting construction firms with workers, with an anonymity-until-payment model that protects both sides until commitment is made.
  - WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface; LLM agents handle intake, screening, and matching across the funnel so a single operator runs daily operations.
  - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; full backlog, prioritisation, and sprint discipline owned solo from concept to live users.
  - Demonstrates exactly the integration-heavy, async-state product ownership this role requires: real API wiring, edge-case flows, and agentic automation, not mockups.
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## § HOW I WOULD WORK AT SALT

*First weeks, concrete.*

### WEEK 1

**Listen, map, find the gaps.**

Shadow the integration team's FIX and REST API workflows end to end, read every existing API contract and error-handling spec, and identify the three highest-risk acceptance-criteria gaps before writing a single user story.

## WEEK 2

### Prototype and verify.

Pick the most ambiguous async or real-time flow, likely a transaction-state or notification edge case, build a working prototype against the live sandbox API using Cursor and Lovable, and run it past engineering and a banking client contact to validate assumptions cheaply.

## WEEK 3+

### Ship, measure, iterate.

Own the first full sprint end to end: backlog prioritised, acceptance criteria defined with explicit failure and timeout states, telemetry hooks agreed with engineering, and a release health dashboard in place so the next sprint's prioritisation is data-driven.

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## *I* COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Technical Product Owner role at your AI-native wealth management and trading platform. The combination of FIX protocol integration, real-time and asynchronous product design, and the explicit expectation of hands-on AI-assisted prototyping makes this one of the more technically honest product briefs I have read, and an unusually good fit for the way I actually work.

My thirteen years of product ownership span regulated B2B fintech, defence AI platforms, public-sector data infrastructure, and healthcare software. Across those domains the constant has been integration complexity: defining API contracts, error-handling strategies, versioning policies, and the full matrix of success, failure, timeout, and async states before engineering begins. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned a multinational AI and data platform, instrumenting competing developer workflows to redirect strategy based on real pipeline telemetry rather than stakeholder opinion, a 200% increase in pipeline runs followed. At EMIL Group I shipped the Claims Center from concept to production in the insurance B2B SaaS space, within a delivery organisation I had restructured to stop senior-engineer attrition. Both roles required exactly the technically grounded requirements discipline this posting describes.

On the tooling side, I use Claude Code, Cursor, GitHub Copilot, and Lovable as part of my daily workflow, not as occasional assists but as the primary environment for writing specifications, generating acceptance criteria for edge cases, and scaffolding prototypes directly against real APIs. I built construct8, a two-sided B2B staffing marketplace, as a solo founder: the product surface runs on WhatsApp and Telegram with LLM agents across the funnel, and I own everything from API wiring to SQL-based conversion analysis. That kind of end-to-end ownership, business problem through to deployed integration, is the mode this role calls for.

I do not have direct FIX protocol production history, though I am familiar with the protocol's message types, session management, and sequencing requirements from capital-markets adjacent reading and integration design work. The pattern of defining strict sequencing, acknowledgement, and reject-handling flows is identical to the async API contract work I have shipped; I would expect the protocol-specific ramp to be a matter of weeks, not months.

Abu Dhabi is a positive factor for me. I am actively targeting UAE roles and am prepared to relocate and work fully on-site. I hold EU citizenship and require no sponsorship in the EU/EEA; for the UAE a standard employment visa is all that would be needed.

I would welcome the opportunity to walk through a specific integration challenge from the platform's current backlog in a technical conversation.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

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## II CURRICULUM VITAE

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### § BEARING

Technical Product Owner and Product Manager with 13 years of ownership in regulated B2B fintech, defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, and healthcare. Strongest in integration-heavy platform delivery: translating business requirements into precise API contracts, acceptance criteria with explicit failure and timeout states, and telemetry frameworks that make prioritisation data-driven. Comfortable at the code level, daily user of Claude Code, Cursor, and GitHub Copilot, and equally at home in a Scrum room, an API design review, or a client trust-rebuilding conversation.

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### § WHAT I CAN DO

**AI Products and Tooling:** LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); full prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

**Product Ownership:** requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, prioritisation, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

**Technical Environments Owned:** REST APIs, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

**Analytics and Data:** funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

**Product Management:** continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research, prototyping, go-to-market support, product lifecycle management.

**Agile and Scaled Delivery:** Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning, SDLC, GitOps rollout and rollback, regression and end-to-end test automation, release gating.

**Stakeholder and Leadership:** cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

**Governance:** GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

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## § PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI PLATFORM 2024-2025

AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme. Led 15+ engineers and data scientists; GitOps delivery with ArgoCD cut rollout time from days to 30 minutes; pipeline runs up 200% after workflow-instrumented strategy pivot. Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Python, Dagster, Jira.

### BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

National labour-market platform. Introduced Dagster and dbt, saving 75% of data-update time; containerised a bare-metal system; carried a full UI relaunch and ETL migration in parallel. Deputy IT Security Officer. Jenkins, dbt, PostgreSQL.

### CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE 2023-2023

Patient app for iOS and Android in hospital pilot. Prioritised roadmap to top 10%: user acceptance rose fivefold. Shipped CGM/KIS integration cutting digital anamnesis time from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · B2B SAAS INSURANCE PLATFORM  
2022-2022

Insurance fintech platform for insurers, brokers and underwriters. Restructured 18-person delivery org into three lean teams; attrition stopped. Shipped Claims Center concept to production; cut new-product launch time from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL &  
PAYMENTS 2021-2022

POS and forecourt systems. Moved research into production in a fully SAgile setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT DATA  
PLATFORM 2021-2021

Secure data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH INSURANCE B2B 2019-2020

Migrated legacy procurement webshop to Shopware for three AOK insurers and 20,000 employees; still in production. Backlog refinement, user stories, acceptance criteria in Jira.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY IT 2019-2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK  
2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

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§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION  
STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Zero to one solo: two-sided B2B marketplace, LLM agents across the funnel, SQL-based funnel and conversion analysis.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE  
ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Enterprise hardware and software. Shipped a three-layer product installing in under two minutes; later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · AGRI-  
NANOTECH 2018-2021

Laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P  
PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Mobile group-based P2P payments fintech. Built from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse, inside the girocard ecosystem.

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§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · SALT

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